

Navid Safahieh

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Purdue University	Expected 2027
M.Sc. in Economics, University of Tehran	2021
B.Sc. in Civil and Environmental Engineering, Sharif University of Technology	2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Transportation Economics, Search and Matching, Causal Inference

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Economics of Chokepoints: Remote Matching and Entry Deterrence in Global Oil Tanker Markets

- Maritime chokepoints act as an entry cost, not only a transport cost: because tankers are chartered remotely, days in advance, carriers commit to distant markets under uncertainty, so an anticipated closure deters entry before any physical disruption occurs. Distinguishes gateways (irreplaceable, e.g. Strait of Hormuz) from passages (substitutable, e.g. Bab el-Mandeb); the 2026 Strait of Hormuz restriction supplies the identifying episode.

PUBLICATIONS

Modeling the Accuracy of Traffic Crash Prediction Models

- *IATSS Research*, 2022 (with Rashidi, Keshavarz, Pazari, and Samimi). Models forecast accuracy across 31 Iranian provinces using macroeconomic and road-traffic indicators.

WORKING PAPERS

When Outside Options Shape the Labor Market: A Directed Search Perspective

- Directed search model with skilled/unskilled workers and high-/low-tech firms shows how skilled workers' outside options raise posted wages but can reduce high-tech firm entry, spilling over to unskilled workers through firm composition and wage competition.

The Heterogeneous Effects of Exogenous Shocks on Public Transportation Demand

- With Kowsar Yousefi and Amir Samimi. A gasoline price shock raised subway usage by roughly 3.9%; usage fell by roughly 42.6% during the COVID-19 pandemic.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON 252 Principles of Macroeconomics — Instructor, Purdue University	Fall 2025, Summer 2025
Teaching Assistant	2019–2023
<i>Macroeconomics (PhD), Econometrics, Game Theory</i>	Purdue & Univ. of Tehran

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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| • Bilsland Dissertation Fellowship, Purdue University | 2026–27 |
| • Outstanding Teaching Award (ECON 252), Purdue University | Fall 2025 |
| • Distinguished Teaching Award (ECON 252), Purdue University | Summer 2025 |

PROGRAMMING AND DATA SKILLS

Python, R, STATA, MATLAB, Claude Code; structural modeling, numerical equilibrium computation, simulation-based methods. Languages: Farsi (Native), English (Fluent)